

PLAYER HANDBOOK

Character creation, simple rules, kindreds, jobs, spells, gear, and a worked example



THISTLEBRIGHT ADVENTURES

Scottish fairy myth, high fantasy, safe wonder, and table rules made for brave young players.

How to use this book

1. Choose who helps as the Guide.
2. Make a hero in five easy steps.
3. Use Brave, Kind, and Quick when a roll is exciting.
4. Keep the story warm: heroes can be muddy, surprised, or silly, but never shamed.



Table feel: point at the picture, ask what the hero notices, then roll only when it is exciting.

For ages 5–7: read choices aloud, let children point to pictures, and use stars or stickers for stats instead of lots of numbers.

What you need

- One six-sided die.
- A pencil, character sheet, and three little counters.
- A grown-up or older sibling Guide.
- A promise to listen and take turns.

What players say

- “I help.”
- “I try the brave thing.”
- “Can I talk to it?”
- “I look closer.”
- “Can my friend help?”

First table promise

Every player gets a turn to say one idea before the dice decide anything.



WELCOME TO THE GLEN

Tiny bells ring beneath the heather. A fairy guide invites the heroes to help a magical place without making the rules too big.

THE EASY DICE RULE

When the answer is obvious, no roll is needed. When everyone leans forward and wonders what might happen, roll one six-sided die and add the hero's matching stat stars.

Total	Result	Say it like this
1–2	Wobble	It goes wrong in a funny, safe, or messy way.
3–4	Yes, but...	It works, and there is a tiny cost or choice.
5+	Bright success	It works well, and the hero feels proud.

No failure spiral: a wobble changes the scene; it does not stop the adventure.

The three stats

- **Brave** — standing tall, protecting, climbing, daring, saying “I can try.”
- **Kind** — helping, calming, sharing, talking, understanding feelings.
- **Quick** — sneaking, catching, dodging, spotting, balancing.

When not to roll

- The action is safe and obvious.
- A child is only describing how they look or feel.
- The group already found a kind solution.
- A roll would slow a warm moment.

Helping rule

If another hero clearly helps, add +1 or let the child roll again and choose the better die.

STAT CREATION

Step 1: Pick your best stat

Put ★★ in the thing your hero is best at.

Step 2: Pick your okay stat

Put ★ in the thing your hero can usually do.

Step 3: Leave one blank

Put — in the thing your hero is still learning. This is not bad; it makes stories fun.

Example: Rowan the Beast Friend has Kind ★★, Quick ★, Brave —. Rowan talks gently to foxes, moves carefully, and is still learning to be bold.

Helper question: “Which one sounds most like your hero: brave, kind, or quick?”

If a child wants all ★★

Say: “Every hero is still learning something. Which one will be funny to practise?”

If a child worries about —

Say: “Blank means story chance, not bad. Friends can help you.”



STEP 1: PICK YOUR KINDRED

Your kindred is where your fairy-tale hero comes from. It gives a picture, a story gift, and a way to join the world.

KINDREDS

Glenfolk

Croft, cottage, castle, or market-lane children with practical hearts.

- **Gift:** once per adventure, remember a local clue.
- **Look:** tartan scarf, muddy boots, treasure pockets.
- **Friend:** knows a helpful auntie, shepherd, or baker.

Thistle Fairy

Small bright folk with manners, shimmer, and secret paths.

- **Gift:** once per scene, notice nearby fairy magic.
- **Look:** petal cloak, star freckles, tiny crown.
- **Friend:** can ask insects and flowers for gossip.

Brownie Helper

Cozy fixers who tidy, mend, and improve small things.

- **Gift:** repair or improve one tiny object each scene.
- **Look:** apron, tool pouch, flour on nose.
- **Friend:** every kitchen has a secret for you.

Selkie-Born

Gentle loch-hearted heroes with moonlit dreams.

- **Gift:** understand water, weather, or a sad feeling.
- **Look:** soft seal-cloak, shell button, sea-glass charm.
- **Friend:** seals, rain, and waves may answer kindly.

Rowan-Kin

Forest children with leaf crowns and careful listening.

- **Gift:** ask a tree, bird, or breeze for one hint.
- **Look:** red berries, green cloak, bark-pattern gloves.
- **Friend:** old trees remember old promises.

Heather Giantling

Small for a giant, huge for a fairy, and very gentle.

- **Gift:** lift, push, or carry one heavy thing safely.
- **Look:** big knitted jumper, pebble buttons, warm laugh.
- **Friend:** stones, hills, and goats know your family.



STEP 2: PICK YOUR ADVENTURE JOB

Your job says what you like doing when trouble appears. Each job has one gift that helps the whole table.

ADVENTURE JOBS

Thistle Knight

Protects friends and stands bravely at the front.

- **Try:** hold a shield, make a promise, stand between danger and a friend.
- **Best stat:** Brave.

Gift: once per scene, turn a scary moment into a brave one.

Loch Scout

Finds paths, listens for clues, and spots hidden doors.

- **Try:** follow tracks, read a map, notice a tiny sound.
- **Best stat:** Quick.

Gift: ask the Guide one “what do I notice?” question.

Song-Spark Bard

Uses music, jokes, and stories to lift everyone up.

- **Try:** cheer a friend, calm a crowd, make a grumpy bridge laugh.
- **Best stat:** Kind.

Gift: give another hero +1 after a kind song or cheer.

Hearth Mage

Carries warm, safe magic: sparks, steam, tea, and tiny lights.

- **Try:** light a path, warm cold hands, reveal a hidden breeze.
- **Best stat:** Kind or Brave.

Gift: create a small helpful magical effect.

Beast Friend

Understands animals and earns trust with gentle patience.

- **Try:** offer a snack, copy animal sounds, ask what it feels.
- **Best stat:** Kind.

Gift: ask a friendly creature for a small favor.

Puzzle Tinker

Builds, opens, balances, folds, and wonders how things work.

- **Try:** fix a latch, build a tiny bridge, turn clues into a plan.
- **Best stat:** Quick.

Gift: make a simple tool from ordinary bits.

SPILLS, GEAR, AND TREASURE



Rule: magic helps the story; it does not solve every problem alone.

Safe little spells

- **Glow-pebble:** make a small light.
- **Tea-steam:** warm cold hands or reveal a breeze.
- **Thistle-tickle:** distract a grumpy creature for a moment.
- **Kind whisper:** help someone say what they feel.
- **Button-bridge:** make a tiny bridge for one small creature.
- **Heather-hush:** quiet a noisy room for one careful question.

Spell limit

A spell can help one small problem. Big problems still need friends, ideas, and choices.

Starting gear

- A snack wrapped in cloth.
- One useful tool.
- One pretty charm.
- One thing your hero drew themselves.
- A spare ribbon, button, bell, shell, or smooth stone.
- A tiny notebook for clues or doodles.

Useful tools

Tool	Use
Lantern	See misty paths.
String	Tie, measure, or rescue.
Chalk	Mark a safe way back.
Wooden cup	Offer water, tea, or kindness.

Treasure prompts

Find	Story use
Silver button	Opens a promise gate.
Ribbon	Marks a safe path.
Bell	Calls one fairy friend.

Treasure is story-first: a shiny button can matter more than a bag of coins if it unlocks a promise.

MAKING A HERO: QUICK CHECKLIST

1. Name your hero.
2. Pick a kindred.
3. Pick an adventure job.
4. Choose stats: ★★, ★, and —.
5. Pick one gear item and one charm.
6. Answer: “Who do I want to help?”

Worked example: Rowan Moonbutton is a Selkie-Born Beast Friend. Stats: Kind ★★, Quick ★, Brave —. Gear: oat pouch. Charm: sea-glass button. Rowan wants to help nervous animals.

Grown-up tip: do not quiz a child on rules. Ask what they imagine, then translate that into Brave, Kind, or Quick.

End of session

Ask: “Who did we help?” “What should we draw?”
“What promise did we make?”

Tiny advancement

After three adventures, add one sticker beside a gift. The sticker is a memory, not a new complicated rule.

If a player is stuck

Offer two choices: “Do you want to talk kindly, move quickly, or do the brave thing?”

If the group gets loud

Point to the picture, name one sound in the scene, then ask one child what their hero notices.